

Helping Hands

By: Jasmine, Mason, Shreyas, Ryan



Identifying the Problem

- Students may need to track volunteer/SSL (student service learning) hours
 - 75+ hours required to graduate in Maryland
- Future careers may require people to track volunteer hours
 - University applicants
 - Med school applicants
- Community Organizations need an easy way to monitor volunteer hours/engagement

Montgomery County Public Schools
UNLEASHING POTENTIAL

MCPSS Form 560-51
August 2025
Page 1 of 2

Student Service Learning Activity Verification

Division of School Leadership & Improvement
MONTGOMERY COUNTY PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Rockville, Maryland 20850

STUDENT INSTRUCTIONS: Complete Sections I and II of this form legibly in blue or black ink. The registered nonprofit organization completes Section III. Documentation of all service is due to the school-based SSL coordinator according to specific timelines. For detailed instructions on how to complete this SSL form, please watch the video at <https://bit.ly/SSLform17>. In order to be reflected on the student's report card each semester, students must submit MCPSS Form 560-51, Student Service Learning Activity Verification Form, to the school SSL coordinator by the following dates:

Service completed during the summer—**Recommended by Last Friday in September**
Service completed during the summer and 1st semester—**Recommended by First Friday in January**
Service completed during the summer, 1st semester, and 2nd semester to be recognized for the Certificate of Meritorious Service (high school seniors) or the Superintendent's 100 Award (middle school)—**REQUIRED by First Friday in April**
Service completed during the summer, 1st semester, and 2nd semester—**REQUIRED by Last Friday in May**
All SSL forms for service completed any time during the current school year, including the summer before the current school year, are **REQUIRED** to be submitted to the school SSL coordinator **no later than the Last Friday in May**.

SECTION I. STUDENT INFORMATION—To be completed by the student prior to review from the nonprofit tax exempt organization.

Student Name (Last, First, Middle) _____ Student ID _____
School — Choose One — _____ First Period Teacher _____ Grade _____
E-mail _____
Parent/Guardian Name _____ Phone: Home or Cell _____ Other _____

SECTION II. NONPROFIT, ORGANIZATION INFORMATION—To be completed by the supervisor after the phase of preparation and action have occurred.

Organization _____
Is your organization listed as MCPSS SSL on the Montgomery County Volunteer Center website?
☐ Yes ☐ No (If No, please make sure MCPSS Form 560-50 (<https://bit.ly/SSLPreApproval>) is completed and attached to this form)
 Federal Employer Identification # _____ Phone _____ E-mail _____
 Address _____
 Describe Activity (in detail) _____

Service Record

Date From	Date To	# Days of Service	# Hours Per Day (8 in a 24-hour period maximum)	Total # Hours Completed (event 1 SSL hour for every hour of service)

Supervisor Name (print) _____ Title _____
Supervisor Signature _____ Date ____/____/____

SECTION III. STUDENT REFLECTION—Think about your SSL activity. Review the Maryland Seven Best Practices of Service-Learning www.montgomeryschoolsmd.org/departments/slp/pages/bestpractices.aspx and respond to the following questions in a written paragraph below, or attach a separate document with your reflection.

- What did you do, and what need did your service address?
- Who benefited from your service?
- What did you learn about yourself, and how did helping others make you feel?
- How was this experience connected to something you learned in a class at school? (for example, English, Mathematics, Science, Social Studies, Arts, Physical Education, Health, Foreign Language, etc.)
- What skills do you use or have open that could help you with a future career?

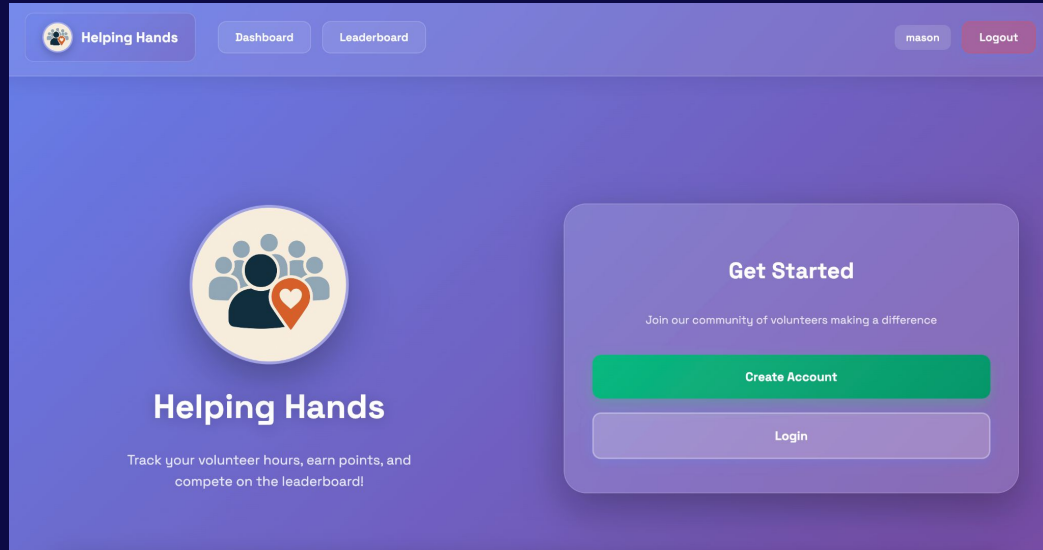
Note: This reflection will be reviewed by the MCPSS SSL coordinator and returned to the student if not complete.

MCPSS SSL COORDINATOR USE ONLY

☐ Check if automatic hours are attached to this activity as a result of course instruction.
 Verification form submitted to coordinator Date ____/____/____
 Hours earned previously _____ + Hours for this activity _____ = Total hours including activity _____ Date ____/____/____

Overview

- Authorization system
- Tracks volunteering habits
 - Total hours
 - Type of service
 - Organization
 - Date
- Award system
 - Earn badges based on number of hours volunteered
 - Compete on the Leaderboard against friends



Target Audience

- High School and College Students
- Individuals looking to log volunteer hours
- Community organizations to track volunteer engagements
- Corporate Social Responsibility Teams – track employee volunteer programs
- Court-mandated individuals
- Purpose-driven people



Purpose



- Encourage consistent volunteer and community engagement habits
- Making tracking volunteer hours simpler and easy to follow
- Fosters motivation and competition through leaderboard rankings and badges

Future

- Implement feature for users to find volunteer opportunities near them
- Calendar for upcoming volunteering dates
- Group volunteering
 - Users can join another user's volunteering activity
- Friend feature
 - Connect with others to coordinate volunteering